



PROGRESS REPORT

Burundi: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-25 • 74 systems and instruments tracked

Of 74 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 36 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-25, 3 did not, 25 carry no stated baseline, and 10 are **Not held** at both ends.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD • GOVERNANCE • FINANCE • ICT INFRASTRUCTURE • DPI • DIGITALISATION • TECHNOLOGY • CAPACITY • INCLUSION • DATA • GEOPOLITICS • WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Shape check, run before the comparison: 76 sources for this place in the window — 20 in the earlier half (2025-09 to 2026-02), 56 in the later (2026-03 to 2026-08). The two halves are comparable, so the comparison is made over the whole window.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

Burundi's twelve months to August 2026 produced four systems and instruments that did not exist at the window's start: [BurundiPay](#), the [personal data protection law](#), the [e-KORI online tax platform](#) and the [National AI Strategy](#). The [electronic single window](#) and the [health supply-chain system](#) completed rollouts, and the [rural 4G build](#) was [contracted twice](#).

Three positions are the same at both ends. The [network's condition](#) is degraded for the same reasons at the window's close as at its opening. Only [500 of 10,000 electronic invoicing machines had been delivered](#) at both ends. And the [biometric identity card, technically ready](#), is still waiting on a legal instrument.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National Data Governance Strategy	Did not exist	Validated; treats data as a public good	ADVANCED
Proposed mobile-phone ban for civil servants	Did not exist	Proposed; no instrument on file	ADVANCED, PROPOSAL ONLY

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Access to information bill	Did not exist	Scheduled for examination; no text, tabling number, sponsoring ministry or timetable published	ADVANCED
Anti-money-laundering and counter-terrorist-financing regime	Baseline not held	Five circulars in force	BASELINE NOT HELD

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
ARCT injunctions on value-added-service consent	Did not exist	Issued; the consumer association reports no significant improvement two months on, and no sanction is on file	ADVANCED
Data protection authority	Did not exist	Provided for by statute; not on record as operating	ADVANCED
Personal data protection law	No statute	In force: eight chapters, an independent authority, criminal penalties, Malabo-aligned	ADVANCED

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
EAC One Network Area and Regional Digital Integration protocol	Did not exist	Joined and ratified	ADVANCED
Vietnam-Burundi telecommunications-technology memorandum	Signed November 2024, no digital follow-through reported	Policy transfer, 50 desktop computer sets and Master's scholarships reported; no monetary commitment	ADVANCED, MARGINAL
AfCFTA country implementation roadmap	Baseline not held	Agreed at ministerial level; no roadmap, country profile or timetable published	BASELINE NOT HELD

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Etats generaux de la communication	Did not exist	Proposed; no response from government or operators on file	ADVANCED

The window opened with no personal data protection statute and closed with one: [adopted unanimously on 15 January 2026](#), eight chapters, an independent authority, criminal penalties, Malabo-aligned. The authority has not moved from provided-for to operating. It was preceded by the [National Data Governance Strategy, validated in November 2025](#).

The window's most informative single fact about enforcement is that the first attempt at it came from the telecoms regulator. [ARCT's injunctions of 29 May 2026 on value-added-service consent](#) are the only written order on file requiring anything consent-shaped of a licensed operator, and the complainant reports no change two months on.

Two instruments arrived at the very end. An [access-to-information bill reached the National Assembly's order paper on 3 August 2026](#) with no published text, in a country that has had no such statute on file. And the [Vietnam memorandum's first implementation meeting in the window ran through the ruling party](#), delivering policy transfer, equipment and scholarships rather than the infrastructure commitment the memorandum's language implied.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Communications and ICT ministry vote	BIF 43.1bn (FY2023/24)	BIF 131.7bn (FY2024/25)	ADVANCED
General state budget	BIF 5,352bn (FY2025/26)	Expenditure above BIF 7,020bn against revenue of BIF 6,296.03bn, up 23.76%	ADVANCED
Whole-budget revenue realisation	Initial BIF 5,076bn, rectificative BIF 4,732bn	BIF 3,234bn realised, 76.79% of the revised target	STALLED
Execution discipline of voted appropriations	Baseline not held	Credits shifted between programmes; a voted line does not reliably execute	BASELINE NOT HELD

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
United States health-sector memorandum	Did not exist	US\$156m over five years	ADVANCED

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
PAFEN Digital Foundations Project	Under implementation	61% committed; priorities are public-finance modernisation, the national identity card and a national data centre	ADVANCED

The financing position is unchanged in kind and larger in amount: [PAFEN reached 61% committed at its mid-term review](#), and tracked non-state finance stands at US\$117m across four deals for 2021 to 2026, all from one lender, on the wiki's own compilation as of 6 August 2026.

Domestic appropriations moved and their execution did not. The [communications and ICT ministry's vote tripled to BIF 131.7bn in FY2024/25](#) and the [FY2026/27 general budget was adopted 23.76% above its predecessor](#). Against that, the same loi de règlement puts revenue realised at 76.79% of the revised target, and the [mid-year work-plan report showed credits shifted between programmes](#).

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
PAFEN rural 4G build	Did not exist	Lumitel >US\$10m for 86 hills across 14 provinces; ONATEL US\$5.9m for 92 hills covering 372,035 people	ADVANCED
Mobile and internet network quality	Outages attributed to power, fuel and foreign-exchange shortages (2025-09)	Degraded; ARCT names power cuts, generator fuel supply, unstable REGIDESO supply, urban bandwidth saturation, ageing transmission equipment and missing masts	NO CHANGE
Starlink licence	Licensed, unaffordable	Licensed, unaffordable	NO CHANGE
Fonds de service universel institutional connectivity	Baseline not held	BIF 11.40bn revised, own-source levy, FY2026/27	BASELINE NOT HELD

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
ICT infrastructure-sharing law	Baseline not held	In draft; no text, tabling date or sponsoring ministry published	BASELINE NOT HELD
PAFEN mast-deployment programme	Baseline not held	Financed and in train; addresses coverage rather than outages	BASELINE NOT HELD

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National data centre	Baseline not held	A stated PAFEN priority; no build, site or date on file	BASELINE NOT HELD

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Powering of mobile base stations	Baseline not held	At study stage, against a network the regulator says fails mainly on electricity	BASELINE NOT HELD

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Regional financial-system cybersecurity measures	Baseline not held	Flagged by the governors; no common measure adopted	BASELINE NOT HELD

The network's position did not move. At the window's opening, outages were attributed to power, fuel and foreign-exchange shortages; at its close, the regulator's own published diagnosis names the same causes in more detail and adds urban bandwidth saturation, ageing transmission equipment and missing masts. What changed is that it is now on the record from the regulator rather than from reporting.

What did move is the rural build. Neither contract existed at the window's opening: Lumitel signed a partnership above US\$10m for 86 hills across 14 provinces in March 2026, and ONATEL a US\$5.9m contract for 92 hills covering 372,035 people in May. The universal service fund's FY2026/27 appropriation of BIF 11.40bn for institutional IP transit is also new to the record.

Three remedies to the outage problem were named in the window's last week and none is an instrument yet: a draft infrastructure-sharing law, a funded mast programme and a planned study on powering sites. Satellite did not change position: Starlink was licensed and priced out of reach at both ends.

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
EAC cross-border secure data-sharing framework	Did not exist	Validated; no national implementing instrument on file	ADVANCED

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Biometric national identity card	Confirmed not ready for the 2025 voter enrolment	Technically ready, awaiting a legal instrument; piloted in about a dozen communes	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digital civil registry platform	Platform unveiled; every citizen to re-register afresh; family-code amendment required	Biometric enrolment operating in 13 pilot communes, decentralised to zone level; the civil-registry to health-facility link for birth registration, piloted since 2023 and institutionalised in 2024, now runs in 123 health facilities and has recorded more than 52,000 births. A national unique identifier is planned with fingerprint and facial biometrics	ADVANCED
Domestic appropriation for the biometric identity card	None on record	BIF 16.0bn proposed in the draft FY2026/27 budget	ADVANCED
Birth registration and birth-certificate coverage (UNICEF)	Baseline not held	84% of under-5s registered at birth; 66% hold a birth certificate (UNICEF, cited 2026-08-10)	BASELINE NOT HELD

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
BurundiPay national instant payment system	Did not exist	Live; 17 institutions in production of 78 licensed (5 commercial banks, 10 microfinance institutions, 2 payment institutions); about 224,000 users and cumulative transaction volume about BIF 4.29bn (4 August 2026); banks, microfinance and mobile money interoperable on ISO 20022 and USSD at ~1,000 transactions per second	ADVANCED
EAC Regional Cross-Border Payment System Master Plan	Baseline not held	The central bank has told the region's monetary affairs committee it expects to be inside the East African Payment System by December 2026, having migrated its real-time gross settlement infrastructure to the ISO 20022 standard, and has separately begun connecting the domestic banking sector to the COMESA regional payment and settlement system through technical training for local banks, the post office and the central bank	ADVANCED
Mobile-money systems interconnected by BurundiPay	Not interoperable	Lumicash, Ecocash, E-noti and Cashtel interoperable	ADVANCED
Payment switch migration to ISO 20022	Not migrated	Migrated	ADVANCED
Electronic invoicing machines delivered	500 of 10,000 ordered delivered (2024-12)	Electronic invoicing machines in use but reported by traders in one province to stop working whenever the power does, halting sales and invoice issuance with every outage, with operators of weak literacy or digital skills reported to struggle	NO CHANGE
Cash share of digital-payment value	Baseline not held	Deposits and withdrawals ~45% of value; ~1.6m of 7.6m mobile wallets active (Q2 2025)	BASELINE NOT HELD
PAPSS accession	Baseline not held	Acceded; four Burundian banks authorised to participate in PAPSS	BASELINE NOT HELD

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Electronic land-title register	Land services digitised (2025-06)	Digitised, with a mandatory fee ordinance objected to on cost and the shortness of its deadline	ADVANCED
2027 electoral register preparation	Baseline not held	Under way and contested; no biometric card in use	BASELINE NOT HELD
Land-title holders to be secured digitally	Baseline not held	About 123,000 holders (2026-06)	BASELINE NOT HELD

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
ELMIS/MEDEXIS health supply-chain system	Partial rollout	956 facilities and more than 2,000 users	ADVANCED
Merankabandi social protection on openIMIS	Migration under way	Running on openIMIS, 1.25m beneficiaries	ADVANCED
CEM/CFP training-centre monitoring tool	Not held	A digital tool for tracking the institutional performance of Burundi's technical and vocational training centres in real time, built by CREOP-Jeunes under the EU-backed Umwuga Akazi project and validated on 7 August 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD
SIGFP_BI integrated public finance management system	Baseline not held	Under procurement, envelope put at about US\$30m; the award is contested	BASELINE NOT HELD

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Daily transfer of telepaid taxes	Did not exist	In force, with a 100% penalty	ADVANCED
e-KORI online tax platform	Did not exist	In service for online declaration, payment and, from 4 August 2026, all new taxpayer registration (administrative and commercial, natural and legal persons, cooperatives); commercial registration routed via the Agence de développement du Burundi's easybusiness.bi and cooperative registration via ANACOOOP, with biometric enrolment for natural persons	ADVANCED
OBR electronic Guichet Unique (single window)	Did not exist	In production, with a pharmaceutical-import module	ADVANCED
Guichets uniques de prestation (one-stop service desks)	Baseline not held	Under operationalisation; the ministry names archive management as still largely manual and service digitisation as unfinished	BASELINE NOT HELD
Paperless Council of Ministers	Baseline not held	Reported operating; no instrument or date published	BASELINE NOT HELD

The payment layer is where the window's clearest movement sits. Burundi had no instant payment rail at its opening; the central bank [migrated its switch to ISO 20022 in February 2026](#) and [BurundiPay opened on 23 April](#), interoperating banks, microfinance institutions and mobile money, with [Lumicash](#), [Ecocash](#), [E-noti](#) and [Cashtel](#) [named as the systems it links](#). The demand side has no comparable movement on file: the only measurement held remains [deposits and withdrawals at about 45% of value and about 1.6m of 7.6m wallets active, from the second quarter of 2025](#).

Tax administration went from paper to platform. [e-KORI opened on 19 January 2026](#); the [electronic single window entered production with a pharmaceutical module in February](#); and the revised finance law of December 2025 [put a 100% penalty on a bank missing the deadline to route telepaid receipts](#). The hardware did not follow: the delivered count of [electronic invoicing machines was 500 of 10,000 at both ends of the window](#).

Identity advanced without arriving. The card was [not available for the 2025 voter enrolment](#) and by May 2026 was [technically ready to produce but awaiting the law or decree governing its use](#), with the [digital civil registry presented alongside it](#). The first domestic appropriation appeared in the window: [BIF 16.0bn proposed in the draft FY2026/27 budget](#).

Registries moved on their own tracks. [Merankabandi](#) completed its migration to openIMIS with 1.25m beneficiaries, the [health supply-chain system](#) reached 956 facilities and more than 2,000 users, and land services gained a mandatory electronic title fee objected to on cost and deadline.

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Villages Numeriques programme	Baseline not held	Under way; no completion date or coverage achieved on file	BASELINE NOT HELD

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National AI Strategy 2026-2030	AI readiness diagnostic run (November 2025)	Validated: governance and ethics, sovereign cloud and data hubs, education and research, innovation and incubators, human capital and about 15 health and agriculture pilots	ADVANCED
Sovereign cloud and data hubs	Did not exist	A strategy pillar; no build on record	ADVANCED
AI governance and data ethics capacity	Baseline not held	One workshop on record; its stated finding is that Burundi holds information rather than structured, consented, usable data	BASELINE NOT HELD

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Lyca Mobile market entry	Did not exist	Licensed with telecom and e-health plans; no service launch on file	ADVANCED

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Local AI builds	Baseline not held	Two named builds; no funding, user base or public deployment on file	BASELINE NOT HELD

Burundi had no AI strategy at the window's opening and has a validated one at its close: [six pillars, adopted 22 April 2026](#), preceded by a [readiness diagnostic in November 2025](#). The sovereign cloud and data hubs the strategy names have not moved past being a pillar.

The external relationships are the other movement. [Talks with India on adapting India Stack](#) opened in June 2026, offering an identity-plus-payments path different from the one Burundi is building. The [United States committed US\\$156m over five years to the health sector in February 2026](#), including health-data management. [Lyca Mobile, licensed in October 2025, advanced telecom and e-health plans](#) without a service launch on file.

Domestic AI capacity showed itself once, at the [July 2026 workshop](#), and its own finding was that the data the strategy assumes does not exist in usable form.

Capacity

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Vietnamese training and equipment provision	Scholarships of up to US\$10,000 each offered, nothing delivered on record	50 desktop computer sets and Master's scholarships reported delivered	ADVANCED

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
University and professional research capacity in AI and data	Baseline not held	One workshop on record; no funded programme	BASELINE NOT HELD

Inclusion

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Internet package tariffs	Baseline not held	More than doubled since January 2025, on the consumer association's account; in some cases doubling or tripling	BASELINE NOT HELD

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Rural coverage target	Baseline not held	80% territorial coverage targeted; no achieved figure on file	BASELINE NOT HELD

Access is the one inclusion measure that moved this period, and it moved against the direction of the build: [tariffs more than doubled over the window on the consumer association's account](#).

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
EAC Statistics Bureau	Did not exist	Bill endorsed; bureau not on record as established	ADVANCED
Population census	Baseline not held	12,332,788 residents enumerated (2024 census, preliminary): 5,901,069 men, 6,431,719 women; 75.0% rural (3,077,593 urban, 9,255,195 rural); reported against the five provinces created by the 2023 territorial reform, not the eighteen that preceded it	BASELINE NOT HELD

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
United States health-sector agreement	Did not exist	US\$156m committed over five years	ADVANCED

India activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
India Stack cooperation	Did not exist	In talks; nothing signed	ADVANCED

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Compute or high-performance computing capacity	A data-centre, cloud or high-performance computing specification, or a hosting contract for a public system.	2026-08-09
Digitisation of communal administration	A commune-level revenue or service system specification, or the instrument behind the communal-revenue digitalisation budget line.	2026-08-09
Earth-observation or satellite data programme	A national earth-observation or geospatial-data programme document, or an agency mandate covering satellite data.	2026-08-09
National technical standards or interoperability framework	A national interoperability framework, technical standard or e-government architecture document.	2026-08-09
Open government data portal	The text of the access-to-information bill, an open-data policy, or a public-sector data portal.	2026-08-09
European Union digital cooperation with Burundi	Any EU or European Investment Bank digital financing, programme or memorandum covering Burundi.	2026-08-09
Chinese digital investment in Burundi	Any Chinese financing, contract or memorandum covering Burundian digital infrastructure.	2026-08-09
Gulf-state digital investment in Burundi	Any Gulf-state investment, financing or memorandum covering Burundian digital infrastructure.	2026-08-09
Digital literacy programme or measurement	A digital-literacy programme document, or a published measurement of digital literacy.	2026-08-09
Data-sharing agreement under the United States health-sector memorandum	The data-sharing agreement itself, a signature date, or a Burundian government statement naming it. The memorandum of 2026-02-09 is held; on the United States government account each such memorandum carries at least one further data-sharing agreement, and those texts are withheld rather than unpublished, in litigation in the United States District Court for the District of Columbia	not yet probed

Ten rows carry no reliable position at either end. The pattern is that Burundi's absences are of foundations rather than of applications: no census result under the registers, no interoperability framework under the interoperating systems, no open-data policy under an access-to-information bill with no text, and no compute or hosting specification under a national data centre that is still a stated priority. Where a system exists, the base can usually date it; where the thing beneath a system should exist, it usually cannot.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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